19 Ways to Make Extra Income While Working Full Time in Canada (2026)

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Quick Answer: The best ways to make extra income while working full time in Canada include using get-paid-to apps like Swagbucks and Freecash, taking advantage of banking sign-up bonuses worth $150 to $700, earning cash rewards from comparison sites, selling digital products or printables, renting out unused space, driving for Uber or Lyft, delivering food through DoorDash or Uber Eats, freelancing on Upwork or Fiverr, tutoring online, and participating in paid focus groups. The easiest ways to earn extra cash on the side include completing surveys during your commute, signing up for bank welcome bonuses during your lunch break, and selling unused items on Facebook Marketplace or Kijiji. These side hustles pay via PayPal, Interac e-Transfer, direct deposit, or cash, and can add hundreds of dollars to your monthly income without interfering with your 9-to-5 job.

Introduction: Building Extra Income Around Your Full-Time Job in Canada

Want to reach your savings goal sooner, or maybe just earn some extra cash on the side so you can treat yourself whenever you want? There are lots of ways you can earn additional income while still holding down your 9-to-5 gig.

Keep reading to learn how to make extra income while working full time and find out what you can do to boost your earning potential. Whether you have thirty minutes during your lunch break, a few hours on weekday evenings, or full weekends available, there's a side hustle that fits your schedule and skill set.

The key to successful side hustling while employed full time is choosing opportunities that complement your existing routine rather than compete with it. Low-effort options like get-paid-to apps can be done during your commute, while higher-paying opportunities like freelancing or tutoring can be scheduled around your working hours. The best approach is to start small, test what works for your schedule, and scale up as you gain experience.

Top Picks at a Glance

Play Games & Take Surveys

Freecash

Get a $10 sign-up bonus

Exclusive: Get a $40 reward from Finder

Make an average of $300 per offer

Best for Mobile

Testerup

Earn up to $800 through offers

No limit on how much you play games or complete surveys

Earn money while playing games

Paid Surveys

LEO (Leger Opinion)

Earn up to $100 per month in rewards

Finder readers receive 2,000 LEO welcome bonus points

Free, user-friendly, and secure app and website

1. *Use Get-Paid-To Apps*

How much you can earn: $0.50 to $5 per hour, up to $35.

How it works: Get-paid-to (GPT) apps like Branded Surveys and Swagbucks offer an easy way to make money in your spare time. These apps reward you for doing things like playing games on your phone and completing online surveys, and the rewards you earn can be redeemed for cash or gift cards. This makes it simple to earn a few extra dollars and cents whenever you get a spare moment, like when you're riding the train or bus to work.

How easy it is to start: Very easy. Provide your email address and create a password to sign up online or via an app.

Required tools: A smartphone.

Effort level: Low. You can get paid to do what you usually do when you have time to kill—play on your phone.

Tips to Successfully Earn

Sign up for multiple GPT platforms to increase opportunities

Complete your profile thoroughly for better survey matches

Check in daily for new survey invitations

Focus on higher-paying game offers when available

Cash out regularly to avoid points expiration

1. *Sign Up for Banking Offers*

How much you can earn: $150 to $700.

How it works: Banks are always on the hunt for new customers, and they're willing to pay to get you to sign up for a new account. Many banks and credit unions regularly pay cash welcome bonuses to new customers who apply for an account. These offers can be quite lucrative too, so it's well worth shopping around to see what's available. Best of all, it's easy to sign up for a new account while you're on your lunch break.

How easy it is to start: Very easy. You can apply for a new bank account online in a matter of minutes.

Required tools: None.

Effort level: Low, but you will need to research the new account to make sure it's right for you.

Current Sign-Up Offers

Offer Reward Key Features

BMO Performance Chequing Account $175 Reward Earn a $900 welcome bonus, unlimited free transactions, $0 Interac e-Transfers, monthly fee waived on $4,000+ balance

Coast Capital Unlimited Chequing Account Welcome bonus available Earn a $600 welcome bonus, monthly fee waived, no transaction fees, $0 Interac e-Transfers, free cheque book, free access to ID Assist monitoring

EQ Bank Personal Account 2.75% interest for 12 months No monthly account fee, free ATM withdrawals

across Canada, no transaction fees, no e-Transfer fees

Tips to Successfully Earn

Read the terms carefully to understand qualifying requirements

Set up direct deposits immediately to start the qualifying period

Keep the account open for the required minimum period

Consider switching banks periodically to take advantage of new offers

Stack bank bonuses with comparison site rewards for maximum earnings

1. *Earn Cash Rewards from Comparison Sites*

How much you can earn: Between $25 to $250 per transaction.

How it works: Comparison sites, including us at Finder Canada and moneyGenius, offer cash rewards when you complete specific financial tasks. As an example, you could get paid a cash bonus when you apply for a credit card, sign up for a bank account or apply for a loan. This bonus is also paid on top of any welcome bonuses the provider might be offering at the same time, so it's an easy way to make extra income outside of your full-time job.

How easy it is to start: Very easy. Just provide your personal details to sign up online.

Required tools: None.

Effort level: Low. You can apply for an offer in a matter of minutes.

Exclusive Finder Rewards

Reward	*Provider*	*Category*
$75 REWARD	*KOHO*	*Cash Advance Apps*
$100 REWARD	*Scotiabank*	*Chequing Accounts*
$40 REWARD	*Freecash*	*GPT Platform*
$80 REWARD	*Neo Financial*	*Chequing and Savings Accounts*
$175 REWARD	*BMO*	*Chequing Accounts*

Tips to Successfully Earn

Compare offers across multiple comparison sites before applying

Stack comparison site rewards with provider welcome bonuses

Read terms carefully to understand qualifying requirements

Time your applications to maximize promotional periods

Keep records of all rewards for tax purposes

1. *Design and Sell Digital Products*

How much you can earn: Varies, from $0 to thousands of dollars per month

How it works: You can make money in your spare time by designing and selling a wide range of digital products. These products are typically delivered online as downloads, such as e-books, courses, design templates and printables. Printables are items such as planners, checklists and colouring sheets that buyers can print out themselves at home. With online design software like Canva at your fingertips, you don't necessarily need to be an experienced graphic designer to get started. And once you've listed a variety of your products for sale on a platform like Etsy, you could potentially turn your digital designs into a source of passive income to supplement your regular salary.

How easy it is to start: It's easy to start designing, but making your first sale could be more of a challenge.

Required tools: PC or laptop and design software.

Effort level: Medium. Creating unique designs, setting up an online shop and promoting your products takes time and hard work, but it's still possible to do after work and on weekends.

Tips to Successfully Earn

Research popular niches and customer needs before designing

Create a cohesive brand across all your products

Use high-quality mockups to showcase your designs

Optimize product titles and tags for search

Promote your products on social media and Pinterest

Related: How to make money with Canva

1. *Rent Out Your Space*

How much you can earn: Varies depending on factors like where you live and what sort of space you have to rent out. As an example, you could potentially make around $100 – $300 per month renting out a parking space in downtown Toronto.

How it works: Space may be the final frontier, but it's easier to rent than ever before. So if you're looking for a side hustle that won't impact your full-time job, why not rent out all or part of your property? The best-known option is to turn it into an Airbnb, but there are also platforms like Peerspace and Giggster that let you rent out your space for use in film and photo shoots, private events and meetings. And if you live in a major city and you have a parking space you don't use, you can rent it to commuters on sites like UrParking and Clicknpark.

How easy it is to start: Easy. You'll need to sign up online and provide photos and information about your space to get started.

Required tools: Unused space that you can rent out, plus any cleaning equipment and supplies you need to keep each area in good condition.

Effort level: Medium. While there's minimal effort required to list spaces for rent, dealing with renters and staying on top of cleaning and maintenance tasks requires time and effort.

Tips to Successfully Earn

Invest in quality photos and furnishings

Respond quickly to booking inquiries

Provide excellent hospitality to earn good reviews

Understand local regulations and tax requirements

Consider professional cleaning between guests

1. *Take On Bartending Shifts*

How much you can earn: Rates often start in the $15 – $20 per hour range, but tips can provide a big earnings boost.

How it works: The idea of taking on a second job won't appeal to everyone, but if you don't mind a few late nights, you could apply for bartending shifts at a local bar or pub. Alternatively, look for weekend work serving drinks at private parties and events. You can take on as little or as much work as you want to ensure it fits with your day job.

How easy it is to start: Relatively easy. You'll need to get a responsible alcohol service certification in your province, such as Smart Serve in Ontario or Serving It Right in BC.

Required tools: Comfortable shoes are a must.

Effort level: Medium. Late nights and long hours on your feet aren't for everyone.

Tips to Successfully Earn

Get certified before applying for positions

Start with private events for flexible scheduling

Build relationships with venue managers for regular shifts

Learn popular cocktails to increase tips

Consider seasonal opportunities like weddings and holidays

1. *Drive for Rideshare Services*

How much you can earn: Approximately $20 per hour

How it works: Apps like Uber and Lyft let you use your car to make extra income. Sign up to drive, and you can make money driving passengers from A to B. Ride requests, payments and route navigation are all handled through a user-friendly app, and this sort of work is easy to fit around your regular full-time hours.

How easy it is to start: It's easy to start the sign-up process online, but you will need to pass a background check, and your car will need to pass a vehicle inspection. Your car will also need to be insured.

Required tools: An eligible vehicle and a driver's licence.

Effort level: Medium. You need to be out and about driving, providing customer service and staying on top of vehicle maintenance.

Tips to Successfully Earn

Drive during peak hours for higher earnings

Keep your car clean and comfortable

Provide excellent customer service for better ratings

Track your expenses for tax deductions

Consider airport runs for higher fares

Related: Secret websites to make money

1. *Online Tutoring*

How much you can earn: Your hourly rate varies depending on the subject. Check platforms for average rates for online tutors in your area of expertise.

How it works: If you're a teacher, professor or an expert on a niche subject, you can register to offer classes on an online tutoring platform. You could teach a newcomer to Canada with their English skills, help high school students grasp the difficult concepts of physics, or help college students prep for important exams. Students often need to fit tutoring sessions around their class times too, making this a solid money-making option to fit around your working day.

How easy it is to start: Relatively easy if you join an established platform that handles marketing, though you'll need to pass a background check and verify your credentials.

Required tools: In addition to a computer or laptop, you may need a headset, video conferencing software and other tools like an online whiteboard.

Effort level: Medium – high.

Tips to Successfully Earn

Identify subjects you can teach effectively

Create a profile highlighting your qualifications

Offer a free introductory session

Be patient and adapt to different learning styles

Collect testimonials from satisfied students

1. ***Freelancing***

How much you can earn: You could get paid a fixed price per job or get an hourly rate. Price varies depending on the type of work you offer and the size and complexity of the project.

How it works: Freelance writing, editing, graphic design, social media management, web design and more—there are lots of roles where it's possible to earn extra income working from home. If you're qualified and skilled at a particular profession, create a profile on sites like Upwork and Fiverr to pick up weeknight and weekend freelance work.

How easy it is to start: It's simple to sign up for online freelancing platforms if you already have the necessary skills and qualifications. However, depending on the level of demand for your profession, it could take a while to get your first client.

Required tools: Generally nothing specific beyond a computer and smartphone.

Effort level: Medium – high. The effort required will vary depending on how much work you take on.

Tips to Successfully Earn

Create a professional profile highlighting your skills

Start with competitive rates to build reviews

Deliver high-quality work on time

Communicate clearly with clients

Gradually increase your rates as you gain experience

1. ***Deliver Food***

How much you can earn: Earn approximately $20 per hour.

How it works: Use your car, scooter or bike to make extra income by delivering food through apps like DoorDash and Uber Eats. Friday and Saturday nights are peak times for take-out orders, so it's easy to fit a food delivery side hustle around your 9-to-5 job.

How easy it is to start: Fairly easy. You can apply online or via an app, but you will typically need to pass a background check.

Required tools: A car, scooter or bike, an insulated bag and a smartphone.

Effort level: Medium. You'll need to hustle if you want to make the most money.

Tips to Successfully Earn

Work during peak meal times for higher earnings

Track your mileage for tax deductions

Keep your delivery bag clean and insulated

Provide friendly service for better tips

Consider multiple apps to maximize orders

1. ***Sell Your Stuff***

How much you can earn: Varies depending on what you have to sell.

How it works: If you have sporting equipment, musical instruments, electronics, furniture or other stuff that you don't need lying around your home, sell them for a quick profit. List them for sale on platforms like Facebook Marketplace and Kijiji, then negotiate with buyers to get the base price. This option is an easy way to make money on the weekends, and you get the added benefit of decluttering at the same time.

How easy it is to start: Very easy, provided you've got stuff to sell.

Required tools: None. All you need is possessions you no longer want or need.

Effort level: Medium. Be prepared to deal with hagglers, low-ballers and no-shows.

Tips to Successfully Earn

Take clear, well-lit photos from multiple angles

Write detailed descriptions including condition and dimensions

Price competitively by researching similar listings

Respond promptly to inquiries

Consider bundling items for higher-value sales

1. *Do Odd Jobs*

How much you can earn: Varies depending on your level of experience and whether you charge an hourly or per-job rate. As an example, when we searched TaskRabbit for a medium (2–3 hours) non-IKEA furniture assembly job requiring a car in Toronto, we found Taskers offering rates ranging from $26 to $120 per hour.

How it works: Gig websites like TaskRabbit provide an online marketplace where you can offer your services as an independent contractor. So when you're not working your full-time job, you can get paid to do things like mount shelves, assemble furniture, clean and help people move house.

How easy it is to start: Very easy, provided that you're good with your hands and know your way around basic power tools like cordless drills.

Required tools: A basic toolkit with a hammer, screwdrivers, wrenches, Allen keys and a cordless drill will help you get started.

Effort level: Medium. You'll need to roll up your sleeves and get to work to earn some extra cash.

Tips to Successfully Earn

Build a strong profile with reviews

Set competitive rates to attract initial clients

Be reliable and punctual

Bring your own tools for higher-paying jobs

Consider specializing in specific services

1. *Babysitting*

How much you can earn: Approximately $15 - $20 per hour.

How it works: The classic way of making extra income as a high school student is still a viable option when you're in the workforce full time. So if you're good with kids, working after-hours as a babysitter is a lucrative way to make extra money while working full time. And because you're a little older and more mature, many parents would be willing to pay you a little more than they would a neighbourhood teenager.

How easy it is to start: Very easy. Start by offering your babysitting services to friends, family and neighbours.

Required tools: Potentially nothing, but you may want to put together a kit with some games, activities and even basic first-aid supplies.

Effort level: Medium. Some kids can be angels; others require a lot more work. The same goes for parents, so this side hustle can be a piece of cake at times and tough going at others.

Tips to Successfully Earn

Get CPR and first aid certified

Build relationships with families for regular work

Plan activities to keep kids engaged

Be reliable and communicate clearly with parents

Consider offering date-night sitting for premium rates

Related: Online and offline side hustles in Canada

1. *Umpire Sports Games*

How much you can earn: $20 to $50 per hour.

How it works: Umpiring sports games is another great side hustle that's easy to fit around your full-time job. You can get paid to adjudicate weekend and weeknight games across a variety of sports. Many community sporting organizations are always on the lookout for umpires, so select your favourite sport, grab a whistle and get started.

How easy it is to start: Generally fairly easy. You may need to undergo basic training and pass a test, depending on the sport. Unfortunately, you may also need thick skin to deal with the criticism and complaints that may come your way.

Required tools: It depends on the sport. You may need protective gear and specialist equipment like ice skates, while you may also need to pay for a uniform and a whistle.

Effort level: Medium. You'll need to give up your time on weekends and weeknights, plus deal with players and spectators.

Tips to Successfully Earn

Get certified in your chosen sport

Start with youth leagues for easier games

Stay calm and professional under pressure

Know the rules thoroughly

Build a reputation for fairness and reliability

1. *Set Up a Print-On-Demand Store*

How much you can earn: Varies.

How it works: Running a traditional retail store requires a lot of time and hard work from one day to the next. A print-on-demand business model means that much of the tough stuff is taken care of for you, so it's possible to fit it around your 9-to-5 job. Here's how it works: you set up an online store where customers can order custom-printed t-shirts, mugs, artworks and more. But you don't have to worry about storing or shipping any of those products; you partner with a print-on-demand provider like Printful or Gelato to do this on your behalf.

How easy it is to start: Easy. You don't necessarily need any special skills or qualifications to set up a print-on-demand store.

Required tools: Design software.

Effort level: Medium. You'll need to create designs (or hire someone to do it for you) and set up your store, but there's less effort required once you're established.

Tips to Successfully Earn

Focus on designs that appeal to specific niches

Use trending topics and seasonal themes

Optimize your product titles and tags for search

Promote your designs on social media

Consider multiple product types for each design

1. *Flip Furniture*

How much you can earn: Varies depending on the items you flip and how much time you devote to this side

hustle, but you could potentially earn hundreds of dollars per month.

How it works: Working full time still leaves the weekend free for side hustles like this one. By browsing garage sales, thrift stores, curbside waste collections and platforms like Facebook Marketplace, you can find used furniture pieces to buy. Then you can restore or repair them, clean them up and sell them for a profit.

How easy it is to start: Easy. It's also one of those things where the more you do, the better you get.

Required tools: Truck, van or trailer for transporting items. You may also need restoration supplies like cleaning products, sandpaper and paint.

Effort level: Medium. Sourcing and restoring furniture items requires time and effort.

Tips to Successfully Earn

Focus on quality pieces with good bones

Learn basic restoration techniques

Take before-and-after photos for listings

Price competitively by researching similar items

Consider specializing in a specific style or era

1. *Participate in Focus Groups*

How much you can earn: $50 to $200 per session

How it works: Market research firms are willing to pay you for your opinions on specific topics and products. If you're willing to give up some of your spare time on weeknights after work, you can make extra income simply by sharing your thoughts and providing honest feedback. Some focus groups involve online interview sessions, but others will require you to attend a meeting in person. But the good news is that they're often held outside regular business hours, so they shouldn't impact your full-time gig.

How easy it is to start: Very easy. Sign up online to get started.

Required tools: You may need a PC or laptop with a microphone and webcam for online focus groups.

Effort level: Low, but the effort required will be higher for anyone who hates public speaking.

Tips to Successfully Earn

Sign up with multiple market research firms

Complete your profile thoroughly for better matches

Be honest and articulate in your responses

Arrive on time for sessions

Follow up on payment if delayed

1. *Start a Blog or Newsletter*

How much you can earn: Varies, from $0 to thousands per month

How it works: If you have expertise or a unique perspective on a topic, you can create a blog or email newsletter and monetize it through advertising, affiliate marketing, or paid subscriptions. Platforms like Substack and Beehiiv make it easy to start a newsletter and charge subscribers for premium content. Blogging platforms like WordPress offer similar opportunities through ad revenue and sponsorships.

How easy it is to start: Easy to set up, but building an audience takes time and consistency.

Required tools: Computer, writing skills, and a platform account.

Effort level: Medium to high. Consistent content creation is required to build and maintain an audience.

Tips to Successfully Earn

Choose a niche you can write about consistently

Publish on a regular schedule

Promote your content on social media

Build an email list from day one

Monetize through multiple revenue streams

1. *Become a Virtual Assistant*

How much you can earn: $15 to $50 per hour

How it works: Virtual assistants provide administrative, technical, or creative support to clients remotely. Tasks might include managing emails, scheduling appointments, social media management, data entry, or customer service. This work is highly flexible and can be done around your full-time job, often during evenings or weekends.

How easy it is to start: Relatively easy if you have strong organizational and communication skills. Sign up on platforms like Upwork, Fiverr, or specialized VA sites.

Required tools: Computer, reliable internet, and communication software.

Effort level: Medium. Requires reliability, organization, and clear communication.

Tips to Successfully Earn

Identify your strongest administrative skills

Offer a range of services to attract more clients

Be responsive and reliable

Use project management tools to stay organized

Consider specializing in a specific industry

Bottom Line

Choosing the right side hustle depends on balancing your available free time with your long-term financial goals. While low-effort options like GPT apps and bank bonuses provide quick cash, leveraging professional skills through freelancing or tutoring offers much higher earning potential. Ultimately, the best strategy is to start small and choose a hustle that complements your schedule without leading to burnout in your full-time role.

Matching Side Hustles to Your Available Time

Available Time Best Options

Commute time GPT apps, surveys, cashback browsing

Lunch breaks Bank sign-ups, comparison site offers

Weekday evenings Freelancing, tutoring, focus groups

Weekends Rideshare, food delivery, furniture flipping

Flexible/anytime Digital products, print-on-demand, blogging

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the easiest side hustle to start while working full time in Canada?

The easiest side hustles to start while working full time include get-paid-to apps like Swagbucks and Branded Surveys, selling unused items on Facebook Marketplace, and signing up for bank welcome bonuses. These options require minimal time investment, no special skills, and can be done during short breaks or commutes. GPT apps are particularly accessible since they only require a smartphone and can be used during downtime.

How much extra income can I realistically earn each month in Canada?

Earnings vary significantly based on the side hustle and your time investment. GPT apps typically pay $20 to $100 per month for casual use. Bank sign-up bonuses can add $150 to $700 per account, though these are one-time offers. Rideshare and food delivery can earn $200 to $800 per month for weekend work. Freelancing and tutoring have the highest potential, ranging from a few hundred to several thousand dollars monthly depending on your skills and client base.

Do I need to pay taxes on side hustle income in Canada?

Yes, the Canada Revenue Agency (CRA) requires you to report all income from all sources, including side hustles. If you earn more than a few hundred dollars from side work, you should report it on your tax return. Keep detailed records of your earnings and expenses, as many side hustle costs (like mileage, supplies, and home office expenses) may be deductible. Consult a tax professional if you're unsure about your obligations.

How do I avoid burnout while working full time and side hustling in Canada?

To avoid burnout, choose side hustles that complement your schedule rather than compete with it. Start with low-effort options and gradually add more demanding work as you adjust. Set clear boundaries around your time, and don't sacrifice sleep or exercise for extra income. Consider side hustles that align with your interests or existing hobbies, making the work feel less like a chore. Most importantly, be realistic about how much time you can dedicate without affecting your performance at your full-time job.

Which side hustles offer the highest hourly rate in Canada?

The highest hourly rate side hustles include focus groups ($50 to $200 per session), umpiring sports ($20 to $50 per hour), TaskRabbit odd jobs ($26 to $120 per hour), and professional freelancing or consulting (rates vary but can exceed $100 per hour). However, these often require specific skills, certifications, or availability during certain hours. For pure hourly rate, specialized freelancing and focus groups offer the best returns.

Can I do multiple side hustles at once in Canada?

Yes, many people successfully manage multiple side hustles by choosing options that fit different times of day or require different types of effort. For example, you might use GPT apps during your commute, do freelance work on weekday evenings, and drive for Uber on weekends. The key is to avoid overcommitting and to prioritize the hustles that offer the best return on your time.

What tools do I need to start a side hustle in Canada?

The tools required depend on the side hustle. Most online side hustles only require a computer or smartphone and internet connection. Rideshare and delivery require a vehicle, insurance, and a smartphone. Freelancing may require specific software related to your skills. Print-on-demand requires design software. Focus groups may require a webcam and microphone. Start with the minimum required tools and invest in better equipment as your earnings grow.

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